

**4.38 South West Rail Solutions Ltd Novices' Hurdle (GBB Race)****£10,000 Total Race Value** **SKY****2m4f**For 4yo+ which have not won more than one hurdle **Weights** 4yo 10st 9lb; 5yo+ 11st 5lb  
**value** 1st £5,281 2nd £2,430 3rd £1,215 4th £608 5th £303**Penalties** a winner of a hurdle 7lb **Penalty****SOFT**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Trainer               | Jockey                   | SP         | OR         | TS         | RPR        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
|  <b>Crystal Island</b> 5 11-12                                                                                                                         | N Henderson           | Nico de Boinville        | <b>4-5</b> | -          | 101        | <b>134</b> |
| Joined Nicky Henderson after winning Irish point debut just over a year ago and impressed when beating useful rivals on rules debut at Ascot (2m5f, soft) in December; not seen since but remains a very good prospect.                 |                       |                          |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Home Made Hero</b> 6 11-12                                                                                                                         | K Bailey & M Nicholls | Tom Bellamy              | 9-1        | 120        | 119        | 124        |
| Drew 12l clear to make winning rules debut at Uttoxeter (2m4f, good to soft) in October and also ran well on next two outings, albeit a late faller on first occasion; might have to settle for a minor role in this deep race, though. |                       |                          |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Kings Champion</b> 6 11-12                                                                                                                         | O Murphy              | Sean Bowen               | 4-1        | 124        | 111        | 131        |
| Won easily at Ayr (2m4f, soft) in January, his second hurdling start, and was not discredited when second to useful rival at Taunton (2m3f, heavy; front pair well clear) in February; ought to make his presence felt.                 |                       |                          |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Rathkenny</b> 6 11-12                                                                                                                              | N Mulholland          | Conor O'Farrell          | 12-1       | 123        | <b>123</b> | 127        |
| Pulled up in last month's EBF Final at Sandown but looked promising beforehand, most notably when winning Doncaster maiden (2m3f, soft) in January; each-way claims if back on song.                                                    |                       |                          |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Uptown Dandy</b> 6 11-12                                                                                                                           | B Pauling             | Ben Jones                | 11-2       | <b>125</b> | 98         | 126        |
| Delivered on earlier promise when winning C&D (heavy) maiden last month, recovering well from slow jump at third-last flight; ran to fairly useful level that day but probably needs to improve again to land this prize.               |                       |                          |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Axel Bleue</b> 6 11-5t                                                                                                                            | M Bowen               | James Bowen              | 33-1       | 107        | 75         | 115        |
| Point and dual bumper winner in 2025; fair form when runner-up in two 2m7f novice hurdles in October but absent since pulled up on handicap debut in November and faces tough assignment here.                                          |                       |                          |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Cedar Creek</b> 5 11-5                                                                                                                           | Miss R Curtis         | Jonathan Burke           | 16-1       | -          | -          | -          |
| Flat-bred 5yo who won good-ground junior bumper at Aintree in November 2024 and was not disgraced in Cheltenham Listed event a few weeks later; makes hurdle debut after 475-day absence and in a strong race, though.                  |                       |                          |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Dylans Moon</b> 6 11-5                                                                                                                           | T Ellis               | Jack Andrews             | 20-1       | -          | 77         | 119        |
| Made pleasing debut when third of nine in Uttoxeter novice hurdle (2m4f, soft) last month and has obvious scope for improvement but needs to take a good step forward here.                                                             |                       |                          |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Fairye Forth</b> 7 11-5                                                                                                                          | Miss R Curtis         | Toby McCain-Mitchell (5) | 33-1       | -          | 74         | 118        |
| Irish point winner who was very respectable third of seven on recent rules debut at Chepstow (2m7f, good to soft); will find much easier opportunities than this in due course, though.                                                 |                       |                          |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Malinaero</b> 5 11-5                                                                                                                             | Mrs C Williams        | Jonjo O'Neill Jr         | 100-1      | -          | 46         | 98         |
| Showed only minor promise on first two outings (bumper/2m3f hurdle) and cannot be recommended in this company.                                                                                                                          |                       |                          |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Pappariche</b> 6 10-12                                                                                                                           | C Williams            | Jack Tudor               | 100-1      | -          | 75         | 99         |
| Won a small-field Irish point last February (heavy ground) but was well-beaten 100-1 shot over C&D on rules debut nine days ago.                                                                                                        |                       |                          |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Yellow Card</b> 4 10-9                                                                                                                           | M Bowen               | Shane Fenelon (5)        | 66-1       | -          | 60         | 80         |
| Dual Flat winner with some fairly useful middle-distance form on his CV; unseated rider at second flight on hurdle debut in September, though, and was well beaten at Fontwell the following month.                                     |                       |                          |            |            |            |            |

**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** This novice hurdle has strength and depth but there is still no strong temptation to oppose **CRYSTAL ISLAND**, who impressed on his rules debut at Ascot and could still be anything. Ayr winner **Kings Champion** ran well behind a good horse at Taunton last time and may put up most resistance. **Uptown Dandy**, **Home Made Hero**, **Rathkenny** and **Dylans Moon** should be in the mix for minor honours.[Chris Wilson]

**5.12 SWRSL - Dan Boulton Novices' Handicap Hurdle****£6,150 Total Race Value** **SKY****3m**

For 4yo+ Rated 0-105 Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after April 11th, each hurdle won 7lb Penalty value 1st £3,247.81 2nd £1,494.44 3rd £747.23 4th £373.92 5th £186.35

**SOFT**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                               | Trainer               | Jockey            | SP         | OR         | TS         | RPR        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>Air Apparent</b> 6 12-0                    | J S Mullins           | Paul O'Brien      | 10-1       | <b>105</b> | 80         | 102        |
| Kept on for third in Hereford maiden (2m3f, good) last month, his fourth start over hurdles, and has plenty of scope for further improvement in staying handicaps; no surprise if he features.                                                                             |                                               |                       |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>Washington Parks</b> 7 11-13t <sup>1</sup> | K Bailey & M Nicholls | Tom Bellamy       | 10-1       | 104        | 98         | 104        |
| 0-6 over hurdles when based in Ireland and absent since two down-the-field handicap runs last April (2m3f/2m4f), but still worth a glance in the betting before this stable debut; tongue-tie added.                                                                       |                                               |                       |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>Hidden Target</b> 7 11-11                  | R Phillips            | Gavin Sheehan     | 5-1        | 102        | 78         | 106        |
| Bettered low-key handicap debut when keeping-on third at Chepstow (2m3f, good to soft) last month; 1lb lower here and pedigree suggests this longer trip will suit; high on the list.                                                                                      |                                               |                       |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>Smile Back</b> 6 11-9                      | R Phillips            | Harry Bannister   | 14-1       | 100        | <b>102</b> | 104        |
| Placed in three of her four handicaps but was beaten about 19l when weakening third at Carlisle (3m1f, soft) in February and is not making any progress; hood left off here; stablemate Hidden Target appeals more.                                                        |                                               |                       |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>Golden Prince</b> 5 11-9                   | C Williams            | Jack Tudor        | 5-1        | 100        | 98         | 101        |
| Unexposed 5yo who was evidently suited by the hike up in trip when third on handicap debut at Bangor (2m7f, good) three weeks ago; probably still has potential; might be the answer.                                                                                      |                                               |                       |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>Kastellion</b> 6 11-8                      | Mel Rowley            | Charlie Hammond   | 7-1        | 99         | 99         | 104        |
| Kept on for third on handicap debut at Southwell (2m4f, soft) in February but was disappointing favourite when weakening fourth at Bangor (2m7f, good) last month and needs a better effort here.                                                                          |                                               |                       |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Moon Over Clyro</b> 6 11-8p <sup>1</sup>   | R Llewellyn           | Charlie Price     | 33-1       | 99         | 53         | 106        |
| Placed in two 2m Worcester maidens towards end of last summer but struggled in his first two handicaps (2m3f/2m2f); hiked up in trip with cheekpieces added today; leap of faith required to support him.                                                                  |                                               |                       |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Fanny Moon</b> 6 11-7                      | Mel Rowley            | Charlie Deutsch   | 25-1       | 98         | 67         | 105        |
| Unexposed after only four hurdle runs but was soundly beaten on last month's handicap debut at Bangor (2m3f, good); goes beyond about 2m5f for first time here.                                                                                                            |                                               |                       |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Stiletto</b> 8 11-7p                       | Mrs S Leech           | Sean Bowen        | 12-1       | 98         | 96         | 106        |
| Did well for new stable in early part of season, winning three times under Sean Bowen (2m2f-3m, good/good to soft); returned from break with low-key run last month but has the champion jockey back on board today.                                                       |                                               |                       |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Getaway King</b> 8 11-4tp <sup>1</sup>     | F O'Brien             | Tom Broughton (5) | 8-1        | 95         | -          | -          |
| Ex-Irish 8yo who started off for Fergal O'Brien with three chase wins (2m4f-2m5f) in the autumn; returned with a lesser effort in February and fell when last in action but remains unexposed over 3m; sports first-time cheekpieces for hurdling debut; could have a say. |                                               |                       |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Dessie Haze</b> 8 11-3                     | P Dando               | Ellis Collier (5) | <b>4-1</b> | 94         | 86         | <b>110</b> |
| Beat well-handicapped, odds-on favourite when staying on well to open account at Chepstow (2m7f, good to soft) 19 days ago, his eighth start over hurdles; 6lb higher here but may yet have more to offer.                                                                 |                                               |                       |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Glenmuick</b> 5 10-5p <sup>1</sup>         | C Longsdon            | Lilly Pinchin     | 33-1       | 82         | 89         | 109        |
| Soundly beaten in first three handicap hurdles (2m-2m4f); needs combination of new trip and first-time cheekpieces to enable huge improvement.                                                                                                                             |                                               |                       |                   |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                         | <b>Eaststone Buck'S</b> 5 10-2                | Miss V Williams       | Ned Fox (3)       | 8-1        | 79         | 73         | 106        |
| Well beaten in his three qualifying races (1m7f-2m4f) but fared better when keeping-on second (no match for winner) on handicap debut at Stratford (2m6f, soft) six weeks ago; 2lb wrong here but remains unexposed.                                                       |                                               |                       |                   |            |            |            |            |

**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** This is quite competitive for the grade, with several runners unexposed over 3m. **GOLDEN PRINCE** bumped into a big Dan Skelton-trained gamble when placed on last month's handicap debut at Bangor and is taken to build on that performance. **Hidden Target** moves up in trip after keeping on well for third over 2m3f at Chepstow last month and is earmarked as a likely danger. **Dessie Haze** may have been slightly flattered by the way the race panned out when winning at Chepstow but he's still respected, while **Stiletto** probably needed his recent reappearance run and is reunited with Sean Bowen today.[Chris Wilson]

**5.42 South West Rail Solutions Handicap Chase (GBB Race)****£8,900** Total Race Value **SKY****2m31/2f**

For 5yo+ Rated 0-120 (also open to such horses rated 121 and 122 - see Standard Conditions) Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after April 11th, each chase won 7lb **Penalty value 1st** £4,700.09 **2nd** £2,162.70 **3rd** £1,081.35 **4th** £541.12 **5th** £269.67

**SOFT**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Trainer                                         | Jockey            | SP                 | OR         | TS         | RPR        |            |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Bowenspark</b> 8 12-1p                       | H Daly            | Sam Twiston-Davies | 8-1        | <b>121</b> | 96         | 120        |
| Came good over fences with small-field win at Uttoxeter (2m4f, good to soft) in February but was not in the same form on his latest outing and ran poorly the only previous time he wore cheekpieces; others look safer.                                                                                                                               |                                                 |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Hold Up La Colmine</b> 9 11-10p <sup>1</sup> | P Hobbs & J White | Ben Jones          | 8-1        | 116        | 112        | 124        |
| Won by wide-margin on seasonal debut at Windsor (2m4f, good to soft) in November but subsequent hurdle/chase form has been underwhelming; needs new cheekpieces to provoke a response.                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                 |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Gaelic Rambler</b> 6 11-9tp                  | J & A J O'Neill   | Jonjo O'Neill Jr   | 4-1        | 115        | 104        | 124        |
| Low-mileage 6yo who unseated rider on chase/handicap debut in January but has made the frame on all three starts since; form of last month's Wetherby second (1m7f, good; first-time cheekpieces) has recently been franked by the winner, and this fellow ought to be suited by this move back up in trip; contender.                                 |                                                 |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Jaccours</b> 7 11-9                          | O Murphy          | Sean Bowen         | <b>3-1</b> | 115        | -          | -          |
| 1-5 over hurdles, the win gained in course maiden (2m4f, heavy) in January; flopped when warm favourite for chase/handicap debut the following month but could still have a good future over fences.                                                                                                                                                   |                                                 |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Lermoos Legend</b> 11 11-6tp                 | M Bowen           | James Bowen        | 10-1       | 112        | <b>120</b> | 124        |
| Gained five of his nine chase wins at this track (2m/2m3f) but absent since below-par run in October and still on a fairly tough mark.                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                 |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <b>Jeu D'Opale</b> 8 11-5                       | Miss V Williams   | Charlie Deutsch    | 4-1        | 111        | 99         | <b>129</b> |
| Ex-French 8yo who opened British account at sixth attempt, with ready success at Wincanton (2m4f, heavy) in February; 9lb higher here and may not want the ground to dry out too much but further progress is possible.                                                                                                                                |                                                 |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Latenightrumble</b> 9 11-4tb <sup>1</sup>    | T Ellis           | Jack Andrews       | 10-1       | 110        | 99         | 125        |
| On a good mark now and was seemingly back in good form when close fourth of 11 at Chepstow (2m7f, soft) in February; tended to jump left and was below that level without cheekpieces at Carlisle (3m) last month but has possibilities if combination of drop back in trip, first-time blinkers and return to a left-handed track has desired effect. |                                                 |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Brulure Noire</b> 9 10-13                    | R Bandey          | Harry Bannister    | 8-1        | 105        | -          | 125        |
| Three-time chase winner (twice here); has form-figures of PU during light campaign this season but is 2lb lower than when clear second over C&D (soft; also suited by good to soft) a year ago; can't be ruled out.                                                                                                                                    |                                                 |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Calli Black</b> 8 10-2                       | D Weston          | James Davies       | 25-1       | 94         | 114        | 124        |
| Won readily at Worcester (2m4f, good) last spring and is still lightly raced over fences but her subsequent three runs (latest was over hurdles) were disappointing and she's 2lb wrong on first outing since December.                                                                                                                                |                                                 |                   |                    |            |            |            |            |

**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** Cases can be made for a few of these but top of the list is low-mileage 6yo **GAELIC RAMBLER (nap)**, who chased home a revitalised subsequent winner at Wetherby last month and might be seen to better effect over today's longer trip. **Latenightrumble** is second choice but **Brulure Noire**, **Jeu d'Opale** and **Jaccours** also warrant consideration.[Chris Wilson]

**6.12 SWRSL - Alfie Boulton Handicap Hurdle****£7,700** Total Race Value **SKY****2m**

For 4yo + Rated 0-110 (also open to such horses rated 111 and 112 - see Standard Conditions) **Weights raised 1lb** **Minimum weight**  
 10-2 **Penalties** after April 11th, each hurdle won 7lb **Penalty value 1st** £4,066.37 **2nd** £1,871.10 **3rd** £935.55 **4th** £468.16 **5th** £233.31

**SOFT**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Trainer      | Jockey                | SP          | OR         | TS         | RPR        |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|-----------------------|-------------|------------|------------|------------|
|  <b>Chillihi</b> 6 12-0                                                                                                                                                                                        | B J Murphy   | Dylan O'Connor (7)    | 20-1        | <b>109</b> | <b>104</b> | 111        |
| Flat and dual hurdle winner during busy summer for James Owen last year but absent since two below-par runs for Alison Thorpe in October; considered only if lively in the market before this stable debut.                                                                                     |              |                       |             |            |            |            |
|  <b>Trust House</b> 6 12-0                                                                                                                                                                                     | O Murphy     | Sean Bowen            | <b>11-8</b> | <b>109</b> | 89         | 112        |
| Rewarded strong market support when winning readily at Market Rasen (2m, good to soft) last month, on his second run after a layoff, and is now 2-8 over hurdles; 8lb higher here but still commands respect.                                                                                   |              |                       |             |            |            |            |
|  <b>Thankyouandplease</b> 6 11-13                                                                                                                                                                              | S Hosie      | Mr Jack Stenhouse (7) | 9-2         | 108        | 91         | <b>114</b> |
| Dual 1m7f winner this season (heavy/good to soft); gave good account when second off today's career-high mark at Ayr (2m4f, soft) on Friday and has a fighting chance here, providing this race doesn't come too soon.                                                                          |              |                       |             |            |            |            |
|  <b>Caelan</b> 5 11-13t                                                                                                                                                                                        | O Murphy     | Tom Hutsby (10)       | 7-1         | 108        | 93         | 112        |
| Improved to win good-ground Worcester maiden (2m, good to soft) in September and subsequently made the frame in two 2m Huntingdon handicaps (good/good to soft); returns from four-month break on workable mark but riding arrangements suggest Trust House is the stable's main hope.          |              |                       |             |            |            |            |
|  <b>Aeroplane Blonde</b> 6 11-7p <sup>1</sup>                                                                                                                                                                  | S Drinkwater | Benjamin Macey (5)    | 14-1        | 102        | 89         | 112        |
| Has a tendency to race too freely and is usually held up at the back; struggled to get competitive at Chepstow in February and now 0-6 over hurdles but interesting if judged on some of his form towards the end of last year; not out of this if first-time cheekpieces have positive effect. |              |                       |             |            |            |            |
|  <b>Eastern Shores</b> 6 11-4ht                                                                                                                                                                               | F O'Brien    | Jonathan Burke        | 10-1        | 99         | 88         | 106        |
| No match for winner when second on handicap debut at Huntingdon (2m, soft) in February and disappointed when upped to 2m3f at Bangor last month; not yet fully exposed but needs to find something extra here.                                                                                  |              |                       |             |            |            |            |
|  <b>Corner Forward</b> 5 11-1                                                                                                                                                                                | A Honeyball  | Richie McLernon       | 6-1         | 96         | 81         | 107        |
| Showed only minor promise in his qualifying races (1m7f-2m1f) but may not have handled heavy ground last time; no surprise if he gets much more competitive on this handicap debut.                                                                                                             |              |                       |             |            |            |            |
|  <b>Asta La Vista</b> 5 10-11                                                                                                                                                                                | C Longsdon   | Daire McConville (7)  | 10-1        | 92         | <b>104</b> | 106        |
| Unexposed 5yo who was well beaten in his first two hurdle races but kept on to take a modest third at Wetherby (2m, good) last month and has plenty of scope for further improvement in handicaps.                                                                                              |              |                       |             |            |            |            |

**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** **Thankyouandplease** won't be far away if able to replicate the form he showed over a longer trip at Ayr on Friday but **TRUST HOUSE** was a convincing winner at Market Rasen last month and might still be on the upgrade. Handicap debutant **Corner Forward** will be feared if strong in the betting. [Chris Wilson]

**6.42 South West Rail Solutions Ltd Handicap Chase****£6,150 Total Race Value** **SKY****3m**

For 5yo+ Rated 0-105 Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after April 11th, each chase won 7lb Penalty value 1st £3,247.81 2nd £1,494.44 3rd £747.23 4th £373.92 5th £186.35

**SOFT**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Trainer           | Jockey                | SP         | OR         | TS         | RPR        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------|------------|------------|------------|------------|
|  <b>Swift Jet</b> 8 12-0p                                                                                                                                                                                    | R Phillips        | Harry Bannister       | 20-1       | <b>105</b> | -          | -          |
| Fell in his first two chases (both this winter); bounced back with 14l win over hurdles at Doncaster (3m, good to soft) in February but ran poorly when last in action and is very hard to predict on this return to fences.                                                                  |                   |                       |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Tommys Charm</b> 8 12-0tp <sup>1</sup>                                                                                                                                                                   | K Lee             | Conor O'Farrell       | 20-1       | <b>105</b> | 96         | 109        |
| Lightly raced for his age and now 12lb lower than when going close at Wincanton (3m1f, good to soft) at start of last year, but he's been out of form this season and needs first-time tongue-tie to aid a revival.                                                                           |                   |                       |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Bataillon</b> 8 12-0                                                                                                                                                                                     | P Hobbs & J White | Mr Jack Stenhouse (7) | 6-1        | <b>105</b> | 95         | 111        |
| Unable to justify warm favouritism when well-held fourth at Wincanton (3m1f, good to soft) last month but will appreciate this ease in grade, and the form of his breakthrough win at Taunton (2m7f, good to soft) has worked out well; big player if back on song.                           |                   |                       |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Mythe Bridge</b> 8 11-8p                                                                                                                                                                                 | H Daly            | Sam Twiston-Davies    | 11-2       | 99         | <b>102</b> | 111        |
| Placed in four of his five chases, most recently when third in first-time cheekpieces (retained) at Wetherby (3m, soft) in February; won't mind if the ground dries out and he has another big role to play.                                                                                  |                   |                       |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>I Ain't Your Mate</b> 6 11-7                                                                                                                                                                             | C Williams        | Jack Tudor            | <b>7-2</b> | 98         | 34         | 80         |
| Tailed off when upped to 2m5f for chase/handicap debut at Hereford (soft) in January, but the form of his two Irish point runs in 2024 reads very well and he may yet deliver on that promise under rules.                                                                                    |                   |                       |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Esperti</b> 9 11-5                                                                                                                                                                                      | D Rees            | Sean Bowen            | 4-1        | 96         | 100        | 108        |
| In-form 9yo who won four-runner marathon at Fakenham (3m5f, good) in pretty good style last week; also very well suited by this C&D and ground slower than good; respected under 7lb penalty.                                                                                                 |                   |                       |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Gingerbred</b> 8 10-13p                                                                                                                                                                                | C Gray            | NON-RUNNER            |            | 90         | 97         | <b>115</b> |
| Second twice in December (2m7f/3m2f) and now 10lb lower but his form has slumped since the turn of the year; had excuse (bled from the nose) when tried in cheekpieces (retained) last time but still has questions to answer.                                                                |                   |                       |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Ahanaglogh</b> 7 10-8                                                                                                                                                                                  | F O'Brien         | Tom Broughton (5)     | 7-1        | 85         | 100        | 110        |
| Low-mileage 7yo who came second in his first two chases, the latter at Leicester (2m4f, soft) in February; could have untapped potential over 3m and features prominently in calculations.                                                                                                    |                   |                       |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>John W Creasy</b> 8 10-7                                                                                                                                                                               | C Honour          | Bryan Carver          | 40-1       | 84         | 23         | 107        |
| Dual chase winner on slow ground last season (2m/2m3f) but out of sorts this term and has a lot to prove.                                                                                                                                                                                     |                   |                       |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Valirann Gold</b> 9 10-5t                                                                                                                                                                              | Miss H Brown      | Ned Fox (3)           | 12-1       | 82         | 101        | 108        |
| Produced a remarkable late surge to snatch what had looked an unlikely victory at Fontwell (2m5f, good to soft; blinkers removed) last month but this inconsistent 9yo tends to race lazily nowadays and got going too late when back at Fontwell a fortnight ago; other are much less risky. |                   |                       |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Henry Box Brown</b> 9 10-5                                                                                                                                                                             | Mrs C Williams    | Ellis Collier (5)     | 14-1       | 82         | 99         | 114        |
| Returned from three-month break with respectable fourth here (2m3f, soft) in March last time and will be fine over this longer trip, but he's not really been firing on all cylinders since last summer; others appeal more.                                                                  |                   |                       |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Martalmix'Jac</b> 9 10-2tp                                                                                                                                                                             | Mel Rowley        | Shane Quinlan (3)     | 7-1        | 79         | 89         | 107        |
| Kept on well to win from the front at Ludlow (3m, good to soft; front pair clear) in February and remains well handicapped on best of last season's form but he's too inconsistent to rely upon heavily.                                                                                      |                   |                       |            |            |            |            |
|  <b>Stadmallen</b> 10 10-2                                                                                                                                                                                 | Mrs J Williams    | James Best            | 33-1       | 79         | -          | -          |
| Seen only once under rules since 2021 and this season's pointing form is very uninspiring; 10lb out of the weights for this stable debut; could be considered only if lively in the betting.                                                                                                  |                   |                       |            |            |            |            |

**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** He's no longer the force of old but **ESPERTI** looked in really good nick when winning over a marathon trip at Fakenham last week and, with this C&D also suitable, he might be able to overcome a 7lb penalty. Barring one fall, **Mythe Bridge** has a solid record over fences this season and is feared most. **Bataillon** beat two next-time-out winners when scoring at Taunton in January and is next on the list, while **Ahanaglogh** could still have potential.[Chris Wilson]

**7.12 SWRSL - Dan Ward Handicap Hurdle (Div I)****£6,150 Total Race Value** **SKY****2m4f**For 4yo+ Rated 0-100 Weights raised 1lb Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after April 11th, each hurdle won 7lb Penalty value 1st  
£3,247.81 2nd £1,494.44 3rd £747.23 4th £373.92 5th £186.35**SOFT**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Trainer        | Jockey             | SP         | OR        | TS        | RPR        |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|--------------------|------------|-----------|-----------|------------|
|  <b>Midnight Ginger</b> 10 12-0                                                                                                                        | A Martin       | Dillon Butler (10) | 12-1       | <b>99</b> | 61        | 98         |
| On a long losing run but she wasn't discredited on the back of wind surgery when fourth of six in 2m3f Warwick handicap 60 days ago; possibilities off a falling mark.                                                                  |                |                    |            |           |           |            |
|  <b>Largy Panic</b> 6 11-10t                                                                                                                           | B Clarke       | Tom Bellamy        | <b>2-1</b> | 95        | <b>97</b> | 99         |
| Lightly raced 6yo who advanced his form on just his second go in handicap company when scoring at Kempton (2m) 29 days ago; up 2lb but showed a good attitude there and has a big shout with this return to further also a likely plus. |                |                    |            |           |           |            |
|  <b>Lemon Leaf</b> 6 11-9                                                                                                                              | O Murphy       | Sean Bowen         | 7-2        | 94        | 64        | 100        |
| Shaped well on his hurdling debut when second in 2m Aintree novice last May; well held after an absence both runs since at Wincanton and Warwick, but could still do better for leading yard now going into handicaps.                  |                |                    |            |           |           |            |
|  <b>Yourcardismarked</b> 5 11-7t <sup>1</sup>                                                                                                          | T Vaughan      | Jack Hogan         | 14-1       | 92        | 83        | 97         |
| Did not offer much in three maiden hurdles (around 2m) this year but this son of Harzand goes handicapping now and is bred to be better suited by this longer trip; tongue-tie is also added.                                           |                |                    |            |           |           |            |
|  <b>Kellebelle</b> 5 11-2t                                                                                                                             | D Jeffreys     | Beau Morgan (5)    | 6-1        | 87        | 94        | <b>102</b> |
| Arrives in good nick since sent handicapping, third of six at Huntingdon (2m4f) in February; not out of things in her bid for a maiden victory.                                                                                         |                |                    |            |           |           |            |
|  <b>King Berry</b> 5 10-12t <sup>1</sup>                                                                                                               | M Comley       | David Bass         | 11-1       | 83        | 68        | 98         |
| Modest form in bumpers (for Ed De Giles) and well held in three 2m maiden hurdles this year, beating one at Newbury last month; tongue tied for his handicap debut with much better required.                                           |                |                    |            |           |           |            |
|  <b>Could Be You</b> 6 10-12t <sup>1</sup>                                                                                                           | N Mulholland   | Jack Tudor         | 6-1        | 83        | 46        | 98         |
| Yet to show any form under rules, pulled up in 2m4f Leicester novice in January on his final run for Ryan Potter; tongue tied on yard/handicap debut and he could still take a step forward given he was placed in Irish points.        |                |                    |            |           |           |            |
|  <b>Ferando</b> 6 10-6t                                                                                                                              | B J Murphy     | Tom Cannon         | 25-1       | 77        | -         | 99         |
| Looks a low-level maiden and beat only one in 2m3f handicap chase here nine days ago; tongue-strap is refitted here.                                                                                                                    |                |                    |            |           |           |            |
|  <b>Mind Hunter</b> 8 10-3tb                                                                                                                         | B Llewellyn    | Harry Atkins (7)   | 12-1       | 74        | 89        | 100        |
| It's now 12 starts since his last success (2022) and he came in a below-par fifth of seven in 2m4f handicap at Leicester in November; others are preferred.                                                                             |                |                    |            |           |           |            |
|  <b>Lancier Des Obeaux</b> 5 10-2t <sup>1</sup>                                                                                                      | Laura Horsfall | Kevin Brogan       | 25-1       | 73        | 33        | 86         |
| Has cut little ice in three maiden hurdles (at up to 2m3f) this year; tongue tied for this handicap debut.                                                                                                                              |                |                    |            |           |           |            |

**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** Ben Clarke's **LARGY PANIC** took a step forward when gamely getting off the mark at Kempton last time and can defy a 2lb rise with this return to a longer trip looking a positive. Olly Murphy's lightly raced **Lemon Leaf** could emerge as the main danger ahead of fellow handicap debutants **Could Be You** and **Yourcardismarked**. [Peter Entwistle]

**7.42 SWRSL - Dan Ward Handicap Hurdle (Div II)****£6,150 Total Race Value SKY****2m4f**For 4yo+ Rated 0-100 Weights raised 2lb Minimum weight 10-2 Penalties after April 11th, each hurdle won 7lb Penalty value 1st  
£3,247.81 2nd £1,494.44 3rd £747.23 4th £373.92 5th £186.35**SOFT**

|                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Trainer         | Jockey             | SP          | OR        | TS        | RPR        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|--------------------|-------------|-----------|-----------|------------|
|  <b>Spanish Dancer</b> 7 12-0                                                                                               | R Bandey        | Harry Bannister    | 9-2         | <b>98</b> | <b>91</b> | 98         |
| Has been brought along steadily, fifth of ten in 2m Lingfield novice hurdle in February; steps up in trip now going into handicaps and looks capable of better.                                              |                 |                    |             |           |           |            |
|  <b>Lion Of The Desert</b> 6 11-10h                                                                                         | G Harris        | Joe Anderson (3)   | 12-1        | 94        | <b>91</b> | 98         |
| Still a maiden but he failed to stay when ninth in 3m Chepstow handicap 26 days ago; not out of things back in trip.                                                                                         |                 |                    |             |           |           |            |
|  <b>Royal Rhythm</b> 10 11-9p                                                                                               | J & A J O'Neill | Jonjo O'Neill Jr   | 7-1         | 93        | 80        | 97         |
| Winless since 2023 and he's been off the track since pulled up in 3m handicap here in November; handily weighted if resurgent after a break.                                                                 |                 |                    |             |           |           |            |
|  <b>Cumhacht</b> 8 11-5                                                                                                     | Miss R Curtis   | Sean Bowen         | <b>11-4</b> | 89        | 78        | <b>102</b> |
| Yet to score but he comes here on the back of a good second of six in 2m handicap here in February; the winner and third there have both gone in since, so he's a player off an unchanged mark.              |                 |                    |             |           |           |            |
|  <b>Neeps And Tatties</b> 7 11-1h                                                                                           | R Phillips      | Tom Bellamy        | 4-1         | 85        | 70        | 97         |
| Low-mileage 7yo who took a step forward when second of six in C&D handicap last month; she can go well again nudged up 1lb.                                                                                  |                 |                    |             |           |           |            |
|  <b>Forest Spirit</b> 5 10-13                                                                                               | M Bowen         | James Bowen        | 12-1        | 83        | 52        | 86         |
| A fair 1m4f Flat winner but she's yet to match that form in this sphere, fifth of six in C&D handicap in October; needs to step forward after her absence.                                                   |                 |                    |             |           |           |            |
|  <b>Whatmakes Honey B</b> 7 10-12t                                                                                        | Miss H Brown    | Ben Godfrey        | 25-1        | 82        | 66        | 98         |
| Ended last season with a breakthrough win at Taunton (2m3f) but she's offered little this season, a well-held sixth back at Taunton (3m) last month; not easy to make a case for.                            |                 |                    |             |           |           |            |
|  <b>Jour D'Orange</b> 7 10-6p                                                                                             | N Mulholland    | Bradley Harris (3) | 8-1         | 76        | 60        | 100        |
| Still to get his head in front and he came in a never-dangerous seventh in 2m4f Wincanton handicap last month; others appeal more.                                                                           |                 |                    |             |           |           |            |
|  <b>Mancero</b> 4 10-2b                                                                                                   | D Pipe          | Jack Tudor         | 15-2        | 82        | 69        | <b>102</b> |
| French hurdles winner; yet to score for his current yard but he wasn't disgraced when fourth of 11 in 2m4f Wincanton handicap 20 days ago given he was set a lot to do; no forlorn hope from a falling mark. |                 |                    |             |           |           |            |

**SPOTLIGHT VERDICT** Most of these arrive with a question mark against them, so this looks a very good opportunity for **CUMHACHT** to finally get off the mark, with the form of his second here last time out having proved strong for the grade. Unexposed handicap debutant **Spanish Dancer** could emerge as the chief threat ahead of **Neeps And Tatties** and **Lion Of The Desert**. [Peter Entwistle]